

The Noble Garland of Intentions Tantra, from the Teaching of the Great Determination of the Bodhisattvas, the Exposition Skilled in the Great Precious Jewel, called The King of Great Dedication

Ārya-sandhimāla-mahātantra-bodhisattva-mahāviniścaya-nirdeśa-mahāmaṇiratna-kausalīya-nirdeśa-mahāpariṇāmanā-nāma-rāja · Toh 809 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་དགོས་པའི་རྒྱ་ཁྱིའི་བ་ཆེ་པ་བོད་ཆུ་སེམ་དཔའ་རྒྱ་པར་ངས་པ་ཆེ་པ་བོསྟོག་

The Noble Garland of Intentions Tantra, from the Teaching of the Great Determination of the Bodhisattvas, the Exposition Skilled in the Great Precious Jewel, called The King of Great Dedication, is preserved in Sanskrit as Ārya-sandhimāla-mahātantra-bodhisattva-mahāviniścaya-nirdeśa-mahāmaṇiratna-kausalīya-nirdeśa-mahāpariṇāmanā-nāma-rāja. The Tibetan title is Phags pa dgongs pa'i rgyud kyi phreng ba chen po byang chub sems dpa'i rnam par nges pa chen po bstan. It is a tantra that opens with the Blessed One, dwelling on the peak of the jewel, the precious vajra, addressing the bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi. It takes up the dedication of merit, explaining how a bodhisattva established in awakening, who has taken the bodhisattva's vows of training and generated the mind of awakening, should dedicate in order to act as a refuge for all sentient beings. The text is Toh 809 in the Kangyur, where it is classed among the tantras.

In the language of India: Ārya-sandhimāla-mahātantra-bodhisattva-mahāviniścaya-nirdeśa-mahāmaṇiratna-kausalīya-nirdeśa-mahāpariṇāmanā-nāma-rāja. In the Tibetan language: The Noble Garland of Intentions Tantra, from the Teaching of the Great Determination of the Bodhisattvas, the Exposition Skilled in the Great Precious Jewel, called The King of Great Dedication.

I pay homage to all the buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Then the Blessed One, dwelling on the peak of the jewel, the precious vajra, spoke these words to the bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi.

O son of the Victor, here is how a bodhisattva, a great being, who is firmly established in awakening should dedicate. He wishes to act as a refuge for all sentient beings. He has taken the bodhisattva's vows of training and has generated the mind of awakening. His very nature is compassion. He wishes to please all the Tathāgatas, to gather fully the accumulations of the great bodhisattva's conduct, and to attain the wisdom of all the Tathāgatas. He

wishes to play freely through the unobstructed absorptions, the dhāraṇīs, and the doors of liberation. And he wishes to obtain the Treasury of Space itself and the Jewel in the Hand itself. Such a one should dedicate in this way:

May the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, the bodhisattvas established on the ten grounds, and all the vajra-holders, think of me. I, who am called such-and-such, who have generated the mind of awakening and am established on the path, offer myself to all the Tathāgatas and all the bodhisattvas, at all times, completely and without reserve. May the Tathāgatas of great power, and the bodhisattvas, the great beings who have attained greatness, accept me. May they always bring to full perfection in me the great power of merit, firm support through wisdom, diligence, a diligent nature, peace, self-discipline, the state of complete peace, the higher knowledges, and the perfections.

After this, one should also speak these words:

You who are endowed with great compassion, think of me. I, who am called such-and-such, have fallen into saṃsāra. I am bound by bonds and have been cast into prison. I have lost the path of the Dharma. I am cruelly tormented by the enemy, the afflictions, who are powerful and overwhelming. I have no protector, no refuge, no savior, no resting place, no ally or friend, no teacher. I have entered a wrong path. I face toward saṃsāra and have turned my back on nirvāṇa. I am inclined toward the lower realms; I am sliding down into them; I have already fallen into them. I have fallen into the company of non-virtuous spiritual friends and am parted from virtuous spiritual friends. I take what is no medicine for medicine, what is not suitable for suitable, and what is non-virtuous for virtue. I have no master. I have turned my back on seeing the Tathāgatas and the bodhisattvas. I am afflicted by birth, aging, sickness, death, and the torment of sorrow. I have not found happiness, I have not found freedom from terror, I have not found freedom from fear. I am never settled in meditative equipoise. I lack peace, self-discipline, generosity, certainty, proper restraint, and conscientiousness. I do not abide in the absorptions, the dhāraṇīs, the grounds, patience, and the Perfection of Wisdom. I do not abide in loving-kindness, compassion, joy, and equanimity. I have turned my back on the three kinds of moral discipline of the bodhisattva. I lack the great unobstructed wisdom. I do not rest in the very cause from which the fully established Dharma arises. I lack the higher knowledges.

I have not attained the powers. I am without the fearlessnesses and do not abide in them. I lack the occasion to follow the Dharma of non-forgetting. I am empty of good qualities. I am not clothed in the garment of the seven branches of awakening. I am deprived of walking the noble eightfold path. I am utterly tormented by hundreds of thousands of sufferings. I am constantly scorched, constantly diminished, constantly deluded, never in meditative equipoise, and constantly following after the afflictions.

Therefore, may you, possessing great compassion, take thought of me and be my refuge. Be my ally and support. Bring to complete fulfillment for me the path of great awakening, the path of awakening, and the accumulations of awakening. I beseech the ten powers of the Tathāgata, the four fearlessnesses, the eighteen unshared qualities of a buddha, the four kinds of exact discernment, the absorptions, the liberations, and the dhāraṇīs: be my refuge. Bring to complete fulfillment all my excellences. Bring to complete fulfillment all good qualities.

Buddhas, Blessed Ones, and you bodhisattvas who have attained great power, please look upon me with care. Having made great offerings and shown great reverence to all the buddhas and bodhisattvas, I offer myself.

In the world systems of the ten directions there are magnificent arrays: palaces of every kind of precious substance, jewel trees, jewel mountains, jewel thrones, jewel balconies, jewel garlands, jewel parasols, jewel banners, jewel pennants, nets of jewel pearls, jewel vessels, jewel strands, blazing masses of jewels, a hundred jewel continents, great wish-fulfilling gems, and pure lamps, gems, and ornaments of many jewels that sparkle, hung with many golden bells. There are lotuses of gold from the Jambu River with great golden filaments, golden garlands, golden palaces, clouds of jewels, showers of jeweled grain, splendid mansions with cores of jewel and walls adorned with many supreme gems, balconies of jewels, and delightful groves and pleasure gardens of the great holders of awareness-mantras, delightful dwellings, delightful palaces, and delightful gardens. Whatever delightful divine enjoyments exist that have not been enjoyed, all of these I offer to all the buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Whatever various kinds of medicines exist in Jambudvīpa, the kinds of rejuvenating essences, the gems of all times, the foods of superb flavor, perfect and most excellent, the fragrant trees, the many kinds of sandalwood trees that follow the seasons, the red sandalwoods, the great forests ever

abounding in flowers, the many kinds of fragrant trees whose perfumes spread and enchant the mind, the wish-fulfilling trees that have no owner and are held by no one, the many kinds of ocean gems, the wish-granting jewels, and the heaps of many kinds of jewels of Mount Meru, Kailash, Gandhamādana, Malaya, Vindhya, Mandara, Vajra, and the other mountains, all of these I offer as well.

I offer to all the buddhas and all the bodhisattvas the tiered palaces of many kinds of jewels; the caves of many kinds of jewels; the cliffs of many kinds of jewels; the dwellings firmly set upon grounds of many kinds of jewels; the mansions of many kinds of jewels; the heaps of many kinds of jewels; the stairways of many kinds of jewels; the pillars of many kinds of wish-fulfilling gems; the pavilion terraces of many kinds of jewels; the lamps of many kinds of beryl gems; those celestial mansions of the realm of the gods that are lovely to behold; those mansions of the divine cities of the realm of the gods that no one has ever taken possession of; the celestial flowers that are lovely to behold; the instruments of song and melody of the realm of the gods; the tiers of empty mansions that, stirred by the wind, give forth sweet sounds; the varieties of musical instruments that, though unplayed, sound sweetly of themselves; the flocks of celestial birds that dwell in the empty mansions and utter sweet cries; the clouds of jewels that give forth great and pleasing harmonies; the divine gems; the songs and melodies; the trees of fragrant flowers; the trees of garlands; the trees of incense; the trees of victory banners; the trees of pennants; and the jewel trees that have never been enjoyed by anyone. All of these I offer.

In all the world-systems seen by the buddhas' eyes, I offer to all the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, and to all the bodhisattvas these vast clouds of offerings: clouds of flowers, clouds of perfumes, clouds of garlands, clouds of incense, clouds of fluttering silks, clouds of unguents, clouds of jeweled parasols, clouds of jeweled victory banners, clouds of jeweled pennants, clouds of jeweled garments, clouds of jeweled trees, clouds of vessels filled with jewels, clouds of heaped great wish-fulfilling gems, and clouds of jewels of every kind. I offer lamps whose vessels are as many as a thousand world-systems, filled completely with fragrant, clarified oil, with wicks of the finest cloth as large as a hundred Mount Merus, blazing brilliantly.

To all of them I make this request: to those who wish to go to the heart of awakening, to subdue Māra, to become fully awakened, to turn the wheel of Dharma, and to pass completely beyond sorrow, I request that for the sake of

sentient beings they remain for many eons.

Just as the Tathāgatas abide without fixating on any object, and have dedicated their merit in this way, so too shall I dedicate all my merit to unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening. I rejoice in the merit of all the Tathāgatas, all the bodhisattvas, and all sentient beings. I also confess every one of my misdeeds individually.

Oṃ smara smara, vimāna kāra mahā jāva hūṃ.

After this, as one wishes, clouds of vast divine offerings will appear before the eyes of all the Tathāgatas.

Son or daughter of good family, whoever, by keeping the buddhas in mind as the object of focus, recites this great wheel of dedication by day or by night,

Their misdeeds will be completely exhausted, and all their afflictions will be weakened. They will also obtain the qualities described above. If they recite it even once, they will obtain the merit of a hundred Brahmās. Even in dreams, they will constantly see the Tathāgatas teaching the Dharma. Their knowledge-mantras (vidyāmantras) will also be perfectly accomplished. They will also be held and protected by Vajradhara, the Holder of the Vajra. And they will be born in whichever buddha-fields they wish.

This concludes the section on the Great King of Dedication, which teaches skill in the great and precious jewel, from the noble Great Garland of the Tantra of Intention, the Great Exposition of the Bodhisattva's Definitive Teaching.

Translated by the Kashmiri preceptor Dharmākara and the translator, the venerable Palbyor.

Translator's Notes

- The title is rendered from the Tibetan, which is a rather free rendering of a garbled Sanskrit title. The Sanskrit given in the text is partly corrupt, so I have kept it as written. "Treasury of Space" and "Jewel in the Hand" are attainments or samādhi names, taken from the Tibetan སྒོ་མཚོ་ཆེན་པོ་ and རྒྱལ་ལོ་ཆེན་པོ་. The sentence beginning "offer myself" translates a corrupt passage (སྒྲོ་མཚོ་ཆེན་པོ་ལོ་ཆེན་པོ་) whose exact sense is uncertain, and I have rendered it by its evident dedicatory intent. The phrase "the very cause from which the fully established Dharma arises" is also tentative, as the Tibetan is somewhat obscure.
- The passage breaks off mid-sentence, so the final clause is left open. The mountain names (Kailash for ti se, Gandhamādana for spos kyi ngad ldang, Vindhya for 'bigs byed) are standard identifications. The sequence of offered items is rendered literally, with some jewel-object terms (such as lan kan and chun po) rendered as balconies and pennants by best judgment.
- The mantra is transcribed from the Tibetan as given; its Sanskrit is probably corrupt, so it is left as a transliteration. The text breaks off mid-sentence, and the sentence continues in the

next passage. The rendering of the lamp-offering follows the Tibetan measures of vessels (a thousand world-systems) and wicks (a hundred Merus). "Fixating on any object" renders the Tibetan *mi dmigs pa*, here understood as non-objectifying abiding in the manner of the Tathāgatas.

- The colophon title is rendered according to the Tibetan wording and may reflect an embedded section title within a larger work. The Kashmiri preceptor's name Dharmākara and the translator's name, Bande Palbyor (*Śrīsaṃbhava* or similar, in Sanskrit), are given as in the Tibetan; the translator's Sanskrit equivalent is not certain.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.